

1. Introduction

My game idea is a third-person medieval game, named “The Broken Lance”. The game takes place in a fractured kingdom on the brink of a war, where a respected lord Evain Astorio is secretly Malachar, the main villain. The player takes the role of Ser Navi Blair, a hedge knight that is trying to find some glory in some tourneys. As Navi travels through villages, castles, and battlefields, he pieces together the truth behind Astorio's double life and must face him in a final battle.

The style of the game gives exploration and combat. Gameplay focuses on navigating castle environments and engaging in mounted jousting during major confrontations. Allies, informants, and a loyal squire companion help guide the player, while enemy knights and Astorio's personal guard will try to stop you

The general gameplay loop is: explore the environment, gain honor and recognition by winning tournaments and advance toward the final confrontation with Astorio. For the final class project, I would create a playable prototype with two main environments, one jousting event, one enemy AI knight, one pet AI companion (Squire), and a working dialogue system powered by the ChatGPT API.

2. Five Fundamental Gameplay Mechanics

Physics

Physics is central to movement and combat. The player uses a third-person controller, so terrain slope, momentum, and collisions all affect how the main character moves through the world. The most physic driven moment in the game is the jousting system, where the player charges on horseback in first-person and must time their lance strike based on speed and positioning using the mouse. Horse movement is physics-based, making each joust feel heavy and impactful. Environmental physics also appear in swinging gates and destructible props scattered through the castle interiors.

Tactical Maneuvering

Tactical maneuvering plays an important role in how the player fights. Enemy knights have like a pattern of attacks, so the player must time their movement and choose when to engage or avoid detection. During jousting, the angle and speed of the charge matter, especially because you would need to strike the point is lighted in the enemy's body in a short amount of time while holding w to charge forward fast.

Progression Mechanisms

Progression is tied to story advancement and changes in the game world. Winning jousting tournaments builds Navi's reputation, which gates entry into certain NPC conversations. Checkpoints are placed at major story beats so players can progress at their own pace. The final fortress only becomes accessible once all key evidence has been gathered, making progression feel earned.

In-Game Economy

The in-game economy revolves around Honor, a resource earned through jousting victories. Honor can be spent to upgrade equipment through a traveling merchant, bribe guards and earn a higher position in a lord castle. This creates meaningful trade-off decisions: spend Honor on combat advantages or save it to unlock more of the narrative.

Social Interaction

Social interaction is the heart of the game's design. NPCs across both villages and the castles carry unique dialogue connected to the investigation. The ChatGPT API powers open-ended conversations with key characters so players can ask questions naturally and receive responses that reflect what Navi has already discovered. Scripted dialogue handles story-critical exchanges. Cheese, Navi's squire, functions as the pet AI companion he follows the player, reacts to nearby danger, and offers contextual hints to the player. Enemy knights serve as the adversarial social layer, escalating their patrol behavior and aggression as Astorio's suspicion of Navi grows throughout the story. Also, some of the enemy knights have different fighting abilities, some are faster but take less health and some are slower but more dangerous.

3. Content Inventory

Game World / Setting

- Two castle environments with interiors, courtyards, and gate areas
- Two village environments with houses, market stalls, and NPCs
- Open battlefield terrain with elevation changes, craters, and scattered props
- Final fortress with dungeon interior for the climactic confrontation
- Unity Terrain object with grass, mud, and dirt path textures
- Terrain features including trees, torches, fences, and farms.

Player

- Third person controller

- First-person jousting controller triggered at mounted combat events
- Player animator with idle, walk, run, attack, and mounted states
- Interaction system for dialogue and cutscenes

Enemies and AI

- Enemy knight AI with NavMesh patrol and alert/chase states
- Pet/companion AI, Cheese the squire, follows player and delivers contextual hints
- Enemy escalation system tied to story progression flags

Instantiation Mechanics

1. Enemy knight spawner that places patrol knights at set points as story progresses
2. Lance impact effect instantiated during jousting on collision

Pickups / In-Game Economy

- Evidence items (letters, rings, documents) feed into progression and dialogue unlocks
- Health flask pickups placed near combat areas

Social Interaction / Dialogue

- ChatGPT API integration for NPC conversations
- Dialogue UI using TextMeshPro speech panels
- Environmental story details through readable notices and posted decrees

Audio

- Ambient medieval background music
- Footstep sounds for grass, stone, and wood surfaces
- Combat sound effect
- Door opening
- Ambient crowd
- Outdoor environment

Visual Effects / Materials

- Lance impact spark effect

- Torch flame particle effect
- Modular castle stone and wood materials
- Terrain texture blends for grass, dirt, and cobblestone
- Weather or fog post-processing for atmosphere

Scripts / Components

- PlayerController.cs
- JoustingController.cs
- EnemyAI.cs
- PetAI.cs
- DialogueManager.cs
- ChatGPTNPC.cs
- CameraSwitch.cs

Scenes / Levels

- Village of Ashford: Tutorial area and first clues
- Astorio's Manor: Mid-game investigation
- Open Battlefield: Jousting event
- Village of Durnwall: Second act investigation
- Astorio's Fortress: Final confrontation

4. Working Title

I chose this title because it represents the tone and the central gameplay mechanic of the game. "Broken" suggests a kingdom in decay burned by war and betrayal while "Lance" points directly to the jousting system and the knight identity of the main character. Together the title feels medieval and specific to this story.

5. Assets

[Inside of the Castle](#)

[Courtyard Material](#)

[Horses](#)

[Medieval Characters](#)

[NPC Animation](#)

[Fighting Animation](#)

[Ambient Music](#)

[Castle from outside](#)

[Village](#)

[Characters](#)

[Weapons](#)